

Coding & Solution

Phase 5 · Project Development Phase

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This document presents the core solution of the Script-Controlled ACL project: four record-level Access Control rules on the custom table `u_institution_details` that together restrict access by the user's role and by the Branch field value, plus the server-side GlideScript that enforces the scripted admin override on read. All four rules were edited after elevating to the `security_admin` role.

The four Access Control rules

Operation	Requires role	Advanced	Condition	Script
Read	bb1	Yes	Branch is EEE (u_branch=EEE)	Returns true for admin, true for bb1, false for everyone else
Create	bb2	No	None	None
Write	bb3	No	None	None
Delete	bb4	No	None	None

READ ACL script

The Read ACL is set to Advanced and runs the following server-side GlideScript in its Script field:

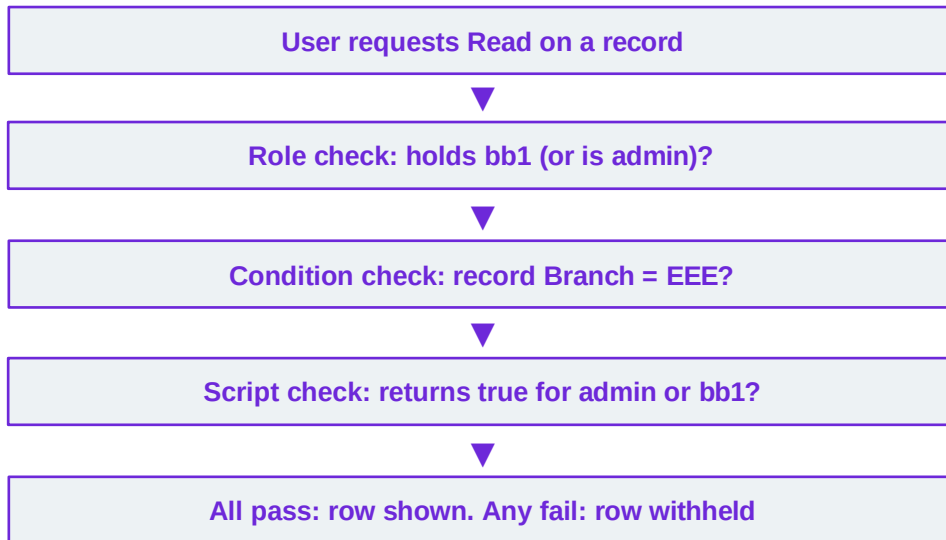
```
(function(){ if (gs.hasRole('admin')) { return true; } if (gs.hasRole('bb1')) { return true; } return false; }());
```

The self-invoking function checks the caller's roles with `gs.hasRole`. It returns true immediately for any admin, returns true for holders of bb1, and otherwise returns false. Wrapping the logic in an immediately-invoked function keeps the Advanced field to a single expression whose value is the final allow or deny decision, and keeps the admin override explicit and auditable in one place.

How role, condition and script combine

ServiceNow evaluates a matching ACL as a logical AND of its parts. For a user to be granted an operation on a record, the ACL that matches that operation and table must pass every check it defines. If any single part fails, the ACL denies, and the record row (or the whole list) is withheld.

- Role gate: the caller must hold the required role. For Read the role is bb1, so a user without bb1 fails the Read ACL at the role check.
- Condition gate: the data condition `u_branch=EEE` means the rule only permits records whose Branch value is EEE, so records for ECE or CSE are not returned to a bb1 user through this rule.
- Script gate: the Advanced script must also return true, which happens only for admin or bb1, giving one explicit and auditable override point.
- Combined effect: the three checks are ANDed together, so a bb1 user sees only EEE records; a user with no bb roles matches no permitting ACL and is blocked with 'Security constraints prevent access'; the System Administrator bypasses the row condition and sees every record, while the script's explicit admin branch keeps that override intentional.



Evidence (from the ServiceNow instance)

Access Control - u_institution_details

Type: record

Application: Global

Active: ☒

Advanced: ☒

Admin overrides: ☒

Decision Type: Allow If

Protection policy: -- None --

Name: u_institution_details

Description: Allow read for records in u_institution_details, for users with role bb1, and if the ACL script returns true, and if the ACL condition (u_branch=EEE) evaluates to true.

Conditions

Access Control Rules have two decision types, and these types will behave differently depending on conditions.

1. Allow Access: Allows access to a resource if all conditions are met. Additional ACLs may grant access to records where this ACL has not granted access.
2. Deny Access: Denies access to a resource unless all conditions are met. Additional ACLs may not grant access to records where this ACL has denied access.

More Info

Requires role

READ ACL: role bb1, condition and script

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true true true u_branch=EEE allow Allow read for records in u_institution_details, for users with role bb1, and if the ACL script returns true, and if the ACL condition (u_branch=EEE) evaluates to true. Existing u_institution_details read (function () { // Allow admin users full access if (gs.hasRole('admin')) { return true; } // Allow only EEE branch users to see EEE records if (gs.hasRole('bb1')) { return true; } // Deny access for all others return false; })(); sys_security_acl admin 2026-09-28 07:15:11 179f7d293e3471068e435018bba10a5 4 u_institution_details global global sys_security_acl_179f7d293e3471068e435018bba10a5 admin 2026-09-28 07:46:08 record

READ ACL XML: advanced, u_branch=EEE, script